Pebble's Ice Cream Shop

Open your shop. Learn your coins.

A pretend play money game for ages 5 to 7, played with real UK coin values.





Welcome in! I am Pebble, I am six, and today YOU are running my shop. Grab the scoop!

Ages 5 to 7

Year 1 and Year 2 maths

Printable UK play coins

TEN MINUTES BEFORE THE SHOP OPENS

Set up the shop, then let the till do the teaching

SETUP · ABOUT TEN MINUTES

1. Print everything. Coins, cards and the shopkeeper kit come out best on card. A laminate on the menu and the coins keeps the shop open all summer.

2. Cut out the coins, the cones, scoops and toppings, and the twelve order cards.

3. Build the counter: menu propped against a cereal box, coins sorted into the till, teddies in the queue with a small pile of coins each.

4. Badge on, sign flipped to OPEN, and you join the queue.

GAME 1 · YEAR 1 MATHS

Pay the price

The customer orders one thing and pays with exactly the coins on the price. A single scoop is 20p, so a 20p coin crosses the counter. Say every coin's name out loud as it lands. That is the whole game, and it is Year 1 coin recognition doing its job.

GAME 2 · YEAR 2 MATHS

Make it another way

Now the till has no 20p coins left! Every order is paid with two or three coins that make the amount. A 45p double scoop becomes 20p, 20p and 5p. One amount, many ways: that is the Year 2 skill of combining coins.

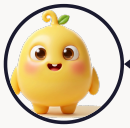
GAME 3 · YEAR 2 STRETCH

The change challenge

Customers get fancy and pay with 50p or £1. The shopkeeper counts the change back out loud, counting up from the price. A 20p scoop paid with 50p: "twenty... thirty, forty, fifty. Your change is 30p!"

THE GOLDEN TIP

Let your child be the shopkeeper, not the customer. The one behind the till does the reaching, sorting, counting and handing back, and the handling is where the learning lives. Your job is to be the fussy customer who orders wrong, pays with the wrong coin and needs correcting. Being put right by a six year old is the whole point.



My rule: the shopkeeper touches every coin. If a grown up starts counting for you, they go to the back of the queue.

Curriculum note for the grown ups: Game 1 practises Year 1 maths, recognising coins and their values. Games 2 and 3 practise Year 2 maths, making amounts from combinations of coins and giving change.

PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

EVERY PRICE IS COIN PRACTICE



Single scoop — 20p

ONE COIN PAYS IT



Double scoop — 45p

20P + 20P + 5P



Triple scoop — 70p

50P + 20P



Ice lolly — 55p

50P + 5P



Super sundae — £1.20

£1 + 20P



Family tub — £2.50

£2 + 50P



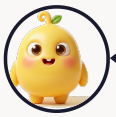
Chocolate flake — 15p



Strawberry sauce — 10p



Rainbow sprinkles — 5p



What would you like today? I always pick strawberry with a flake!

Laminate me. A menu that survives sticky fingers and a splash of squash runs the whole summer. Prop me against a cereal box.

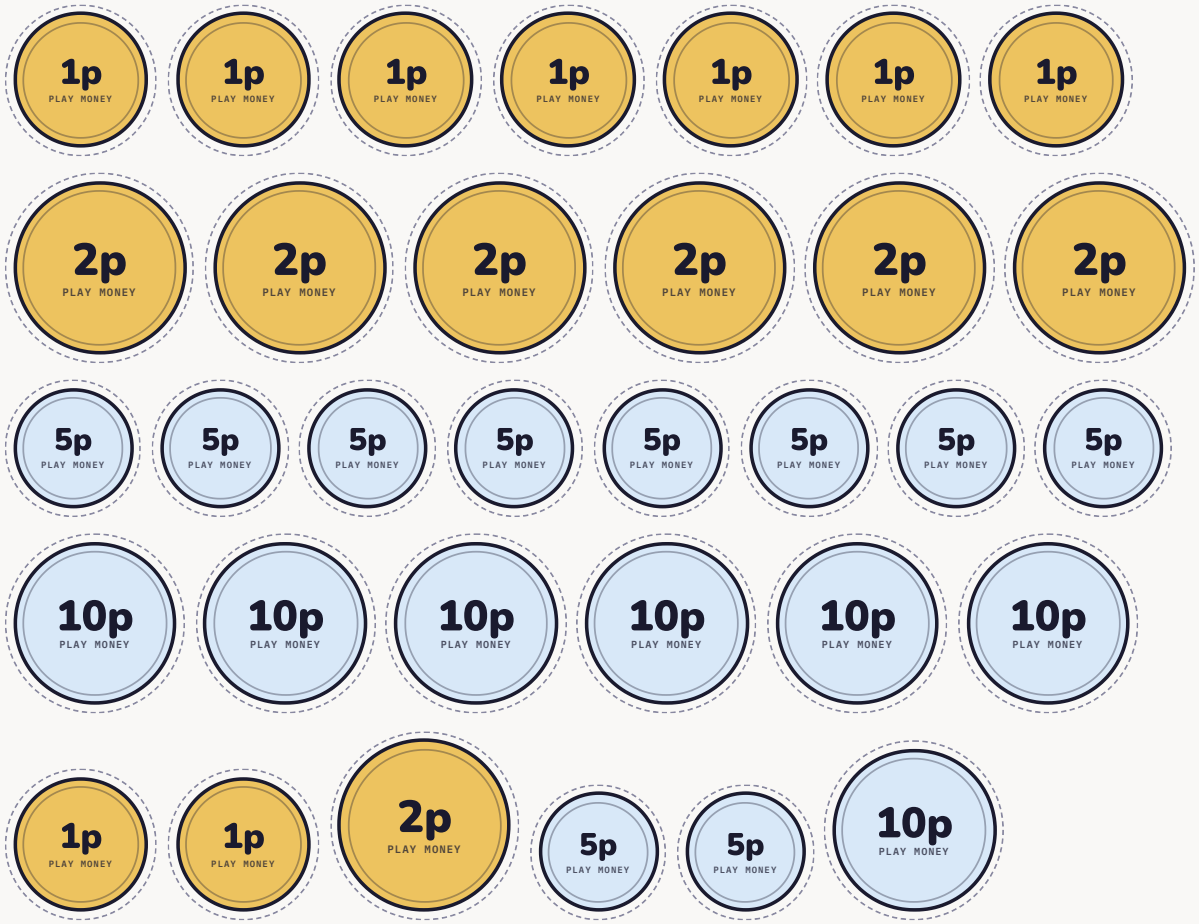
Cones, scoops and toppings

Cut round the dashed lines. When an order comes in, the shopkeeper builds it: cone first, scoops stacked on top, topping last. Six flavours in the freezer: strawberry, vanilla, chocolate, mint, blueberry and honeycomb.



Play money: coppers and small silvers

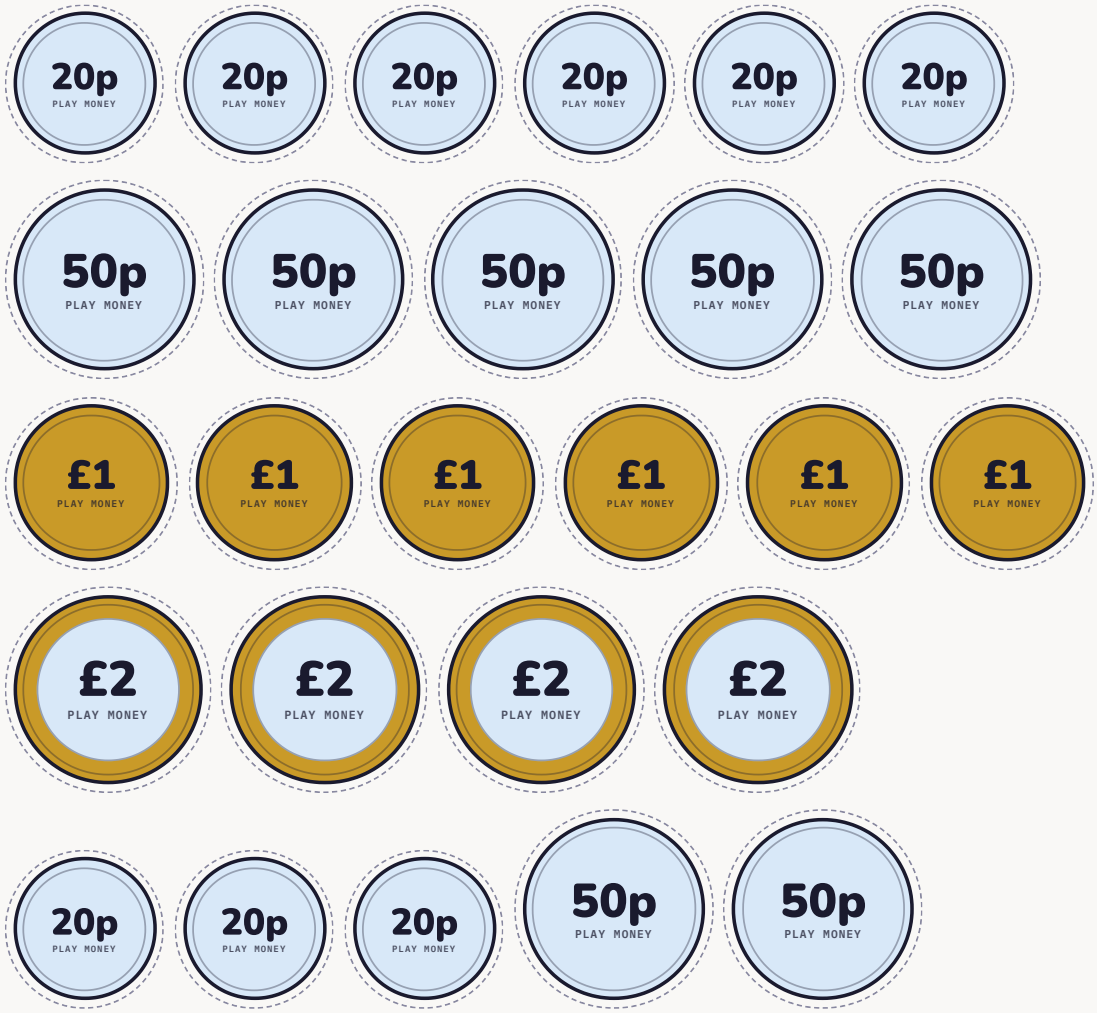
Cut round the dashed circles. These play coins print close to the size of the real thing, so the shop works just as well with real pocket change when you have it. Coppers print golden, silvers print blue, pounds print deep gold, which keeps sorting easy for small hands.



Shopkeeper short of change? Print this page twice. Card stock and a laminate make coins that survive the whole summer holiday, and a real coin taped beside its play twin makes a lovely matching game for day one.

Play money: big silvers and pounds

These are the change makers for Game 3. A 50p or a £1 coin pays for almost everything on the menu, and counting the change back out loud is the Year 2 skill teachers most want practised at home. The £2 coin exists for one glorious order: the family tub.



A note on our coins. These are stylised play coins in Pebble's shop colours, made for little fingers and coin value practice. They are not pictures of real money, which is exactly why every one says PLAY MONEY on its face.

Order and challenge cards

Shuffle the cards face down. The customer draws one, reads it in their silliest voice, and the shopkeeper does the maths. Answers hide at the bottom of each card: fold them under, or trust the person behind the till.

YEAR 1

"One single scoop, please!"

Which one coin pays for it?

Answer: the 20p coin

YEAR 1

"A flake for my scoop, please!"

It costs 15p. Pay with two coins.

Answer: 10p + 5p

YEAR 1

"A single scoop with sprinkles!"

What does it cost altogether?

Answer: 20p + 5p = 25p

YEAR 1

"A single scoop with strawberry sauce, please!"

What does it cost altogether?

Answer: 20p + 10p = 30p

YEAR 2

"A double scoop, please!"

Pay 45p with exactly three coins.

Answer: 20p + 20p + 5p

YEAR 2

"One ice lolly, please!"

Pay 55p with exactly two coins.

Answer: 50p + 5p

YEAR 2

"A triple scoop, please!"

Pay 70p with exactly two coins.

Answer: 50p + 20p

YEAR 2

"A double scoop with a flake. What do I pay?"

Add the two prices, then pay with two coins.

Answer: 45p + 15p = 60p, paid 50p + 10p

CHANGE

"A single scoop. Here is 50p."

What change does the shopkeeper give back?

Answer: 50p take away 20p is 30p, given as 20p + 10p

CHANGE

"A double scoop. Here is 50p."

What change does the shopkeeper give back?

Answer: 50p take away 45p is 5p, one little coin

CHANGE

"A triple scoop. Here is £1."

What change does the shopkeeper give back?

Answer: £1 take away 70p is 30p, given as 20p + 10p

CHANGE

"An ice lolly. Here is £1."

What change does the shopkeeper give back?

Answer: £1 take away 55p is 45p, given as 20p + 20p + 5p

CUT OUT · THE SHOPKEEPER KIT

Badge on. Sign up. Shop open.

Colour the badge, write your name, and pin it on with a safety pin or a loop of tape. Flip between OPEN and CLOSED so everyone knows when the shopkeeper is on a biscuit break.



PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

Shopkeeper

_____



PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

Shopkeeper

_____

OPEN

PLEASE QUEUE NICELY

CLOSED

BACK AFTER TEA

TODAY'S SPECIAL _____ **only** _____**p**



The shopkeeper sets the special and its price. Watch what they choose: a price they can already make from two coins is a child quietly showing you what they know.

THE RECEIPT PAD · ONE PER CUSTOMER

PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

ITEM ..... ___p
ITEM ..... ___p
TOTAL ..... ___p
PAID WITH ..... ____
CHANGE ..... ____

THANK YOU · COME AGAIN

PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

ITEM ..... ___p
ITEM ..... ___p
TOTAL ..... ___p
PAID WITH ..... ____
CHANGE ..... ____

THANK YOU · COME AGAIN

PEBBLE'S ICE CREAM SHOP

ITEM ..... ___p
ITEM ..... ___p
TOTAL ..... ___p
PAID WITH ..... ____
CHANGE ..... ____

THANK YOU · COME AGAIN

Writing the total and the change on a receipt is sneaky number formation practice. Print this page again whenever the pad runs out.

GUIDED CHILDHOOD

Thank you

The ice cream shop is open. Let your child run the till as often as they like: the one behind the counter does the counting, and that is where the learning lives.



A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If the shop filled a rainy afternoon and sneaked in some coin practice, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.